

● WORLD TOURISM DAY • SUNDAY, 27 SEPTEMBER 2026

Belagavi runs through *its own history*

An 8-kilometre heritage marathon carrying 500 runners past 13th-century forts, sacred basadis, and anti-colonial landmarks — culminating in the formal inauguration of the district's AI-rebuilt Tourism Portal.

- 🏛️ 8 km Single-Category Heritage Route
- 🤖 AI-Enhanced Tourism Website Inauguration
- 🎭 Live Folk Corridors at Every Landmark
- 🏆 Medals & Refreshments for All 500 Finishers

DATE	DISTANCE	START LINE	FINISH & FUNCTION	KEY MILESTONE
27 Sep World Tourism Day	8.0 km Single Category	06:30 hrs Lele Ground	11:00 hrs Kumar Gandharv Aud.	Website Launch AI Tourism Revamp

The route is the campaign

Turning Belagavi's living heritage into an active guided tour at pace, paired with a permanent digital transformation for district tourism.

01

8 KM COURSE

Heritage at Marathon Pace

- **6 Historic Landmarks in 8 km:** Course deliberately connects Belagavi Fort, ancient Basadis, Safa Masjid, Postman Circle, and Chennamma memorial.
- **One Morning, City-Wide Focus:** Closed roads direct all civic attention, 500 runners, and regional cameras at Belagavi's signature monuments.
- **Guided Tour at Pace:** Replaces anonymous highway stretches with a continuous corridor of historic discovery.

02

LIVE PERFORMANCES

Culture Staged at the Monuments

- **Authentic Folk Corridors:** Yakshagana, Dollu Kunittha, Karadi Majalu & Veeragase troupes staged directly at landmark sites.
- **Beyond Plain Water Stops:** Cultural points double as high-energy cheering zones and high-visibility media photo spots.
- **Dhol-Tasha Reception:** High-octane finish arch reception welcoming every finisher at Kumar Gandharv Auditorium.

03

THEME ALIGNMENT · MANDATORY

AI Tourism Website Revamp

- **Complete Tourism Portal Rebuild:** Redesigning Belagavi's official tourism platform with cutting-edge AI features and interactive maps.
- **Official Inauguration at Function:** Formal digital portal launch on stage by the Deputy Commissioner & District In-charge Minister.
- **AI Smart Tourist Guide:** Interactive itineraries, digital guides, and multi-lingual voice assistants for lasting tourism impact.

04

PUBLIC MOBILIZATION

17-Day Sprint to 500 Runners

- **Run Club Network:** Direct engagement across Belagavi, Bengaluru, Hubballi, Dharwad, and Maharashtra borders.
- **Creator & Media Engine:** Kannada & Marathi lifestyle creators capturing on-route reels to build viral regional momentum.
- **Medals & Recognition:** Official medals, bananas & juice for all finishers, plus Tourist Mitra felicitations.

● THE 8 KM ROUTE • INTERACTIVE MAP & CULTURAL POSITIONS

Lele Ground to Kumar Gandharv Auditorium

Hover or click any landmark pin on the vector map outline to inspect on-route tourist monuments, historical significance, and live performance details — or switch to the official Google Map route.



0.0k Lele Ground	0.6k Congress Well	0.8k Mil. Mahadev	3.0k Postman Cir.	5.0k Belagavi Fort	7.0k Chennamma	8.0k Auditorium
---------------------	-----------------------	----------------------	----------------------	-----------------------	-------------------	--------------------

START • 0.0 km

Assembly Hub



SUBHASH CHANDRA GROUND • CAMP AREA

Lele Ground

Historic public sports ground and major assembly venue in Belagavi. Serves as the central hub for 500 runners, mass warm-up, bib collection, and dignitary flag-off at 06:30 hrs.

LIVE PERFORMANCE & ROUTE MILESTONE

Zumba & Mass Folk Warm-up session for 500 runners and spectators before flag-off.

● CULTURAL CORRIDOR · EXACT ROUTE POSITIONS

Performance staged at the landmarks, not between them

Rather than generic entertainment points, troupes are placed at the tourist sites the route crosses — turning the run into a continuous corridor of Karnataka folk traditions.



LELE GROUND ASSEMBLY HUB

Zumba & Folk Warm-Up

Mass energetic warm-up for all 500 runners and spectators led from the stage, transitioning directly into the 06:30 dignitary flag-off.



WORLD'S FIRST POSTMAN CIRCLE

Karadi Majalu Troupe

Traditional North Karnataka folk percussion ensemble with bronze cymbals lifting runner pace as the pack crosses the 3 km mark.



BELAGAVI FORT RAMPARTS

Yakshagana / Dollu Kunita

Signature cultural highlight staged against the 13th-century ramparts — the highest photo, media, and spectator cheering spot.



KUMAR GANDHARV AUDITORIUM

Dhol-Tasha Welcome

High-energy finish arch reception with grand drums welcoming every finisher directly into the auditorium for refreshments and function.

● RACE MORNING SCHEDULE

Sunday, 27 September 2026

Morning timeline from assembly through race finish, refreshments, and transition to the formal auditorium function.

05:30 **Assembly & Bib Collection Opens**

Lele Ground — registration desks, baggage counter, medical desk and warm-up zone open.

06:15 **Bib Counters Close · Mass Warm-Up**

Field marshals assemble runners at start pens; 15-minute energetic folk & zumba warm-up.

06:30 **Flag-Off — Belagavi Marathon 2026**

Flag-off by Hon'ble Deputy Commissioner and invited dignitaries at Lele Ground.

07:00 **Leading Runners Reach Belagavi Fort (km 5.0)**

Peak cultural performance and photography window at the fort gates and basadi precinct.

07:20 **First Finishers Cross Arch · Kumar Gandharv Auditorium**

Dhol-tasha welcome, official medals of recognition, and fresh banana & juice refreshments.

09:30 **Course Closes · Road Reopening**

Traffic police reopen the route; runners, guests, and families transition into auditorium foyer.

11:00 **Formal Function & AI Tourism Website Inauguration**

Official protocol, awards ceremony, Tourist Mitra honours, and cultural programme.

Order of proceedings at Kumar Gandharv Auditorium

A unified grand session combining state protocol, the AI website inauguration, cultural performances by hotel management students, awards, and felicitation.

Grand Function • Formal Protocol, Cultural Showcase & Awards

11:00 hrs Onward • Main Stage

- 01

Drum Dance & Folk Reception
Welcoming invited dignitaries, guests, and runners at the entrance foyer
- 03

Welcome Address by JD Tourism
Joint Director, Dept. of Tourism Belagavi — bouquets, books, and welcome speech
- 05

Cultural Performance & Hotel Management Showcase
4 to 6 curated song and dance items including special performances by Hotel Management students
- 07

Speech — Hon'ble Deputy Commissioner, Belagavi
Address on World Tourism Day, AI digital vision, and district heritage promotion
- 09

Keynote Speech — District In-Charge Minister / MLA
Government vision for tourism development and community sports
- 11

Felicitation of Tourist Mitras
Honouring frontline tourism guides, guardians, and cultural contributors
- 13

High Tea & Hospitality for Dignitaries & Guests
Special tea service, networking, and conclusion in the auditorium lounge

- 02

National Anthem & State Anthem
Formal protocol — Naada Geethe (Jaya Bharata Jananiya Tanujate)
- 04

Lighting of the Ceremonial Lamp
Deepa Prajwalana by Hon'ble DC, Ministers, and distinguished guests
- 06

Inauguration of Rebuilt AI Tourism Website & Mobile Canteen
Official digital portal launch on stage by Hon'ble Deputy Commissioner & dignitaries
- 08

Addresses by Guest Dignitaries
Remarks by district administration and tourism officials
- 10

Grand Prize Distribution Ceremony
Awards for 8 km Marathon, District Photography, Essay, and Drawing competitions
- 12

Vote of Thanks
Formal acknowledgement of all departments, run clubs, volunteers, and police

● ANSWERING THE GLOBAL THEME

Digital enhancement & artificial intelligence in tourism

The World Tourism Day theme is not just decoration. Belagavi's entire district tourism website is being completely rebuilt and enhanced with AI capabilities, inaugurated on event day.

01 • AI Smart Itinerary Engine

Interactive planning tool that customises Belagavi heritage trails based on visitor duration, interest (history, waterfalls, spiritual, cuisine), and real-time travel logistics.

02 • Digital Tourist Mitra (AI Assistant)

A multi-lingual conversational AI guide in Kannada, Marathi, and English providing instant historical context, audio commentary, and navigational guidance at every monument.

03 • Interactive Heritage Geotagging

High-resolution drone mapping, 3D monument walkthroughs of Belagavi Fort, Kamal Basti, and surrounding district treasures preserving Belagavi's legacy online.

INAUGURATION MOMENT

The rebuilt AI Tourism Website will be formally unveiled on stage during Session 1 at Kumar Gandharv Auditorium.

● DISTRICT COMPETITIONS

Four contests feeding one grand prize distribution

Engaging youth and artists across Belagavi district before the event, with awards presented live on stage at the main function.

Photography Contest

Theme: "Belagavi Unseen Heritage". High-resolution entries judged across student and open categories.

CLOSES 22 SEP · PRE-JUDGED

District Essay Contest

Theme: "Digital Innovation in Karnataka Tourism" in Kannada, English, and Marathi.

CLOSES 22 SEP · PRE-JUDGED

Drawing & Art Contest

School and college students depicting Rani Chennamma, Belagavi Fort, and cultural icons.

CLOSES 22 SEP · PRE-JUDGED

8 km Heritage Marathon

Men, Women, and Veteran podium finishers, plus recognition medals for all 500 finishers.

EVENT DAY · 27 SEP

● MOBILIZATION STRATEGY

How we reach 500+ runners in 17 days

A multi-channel institutional, school, and digital sprint to pack the start line and maximize community participation.

CHANNEL 01 · SCHOOL VISITS

Direct Engagement

School Assembly Talks & Pamphlet Distribution

- **Direct School Visits:** Organizing on-ground visits to schools and colleges across Belagavi and surrounding talukas.
- **Assembly Presentations:** Briefing students and faculty during morning school assemblies to encourage mass participation in the 8 km run.
- **Pamphlet Drive:** Handing out registration flyers, parent consent forms, and competition details directly to youth.

CHANNEL 03 · ATHLETE NETWORK

Committed Runners

Run Clubs & Regional Sports Groups

- **City & Regional Run Clubs:** Dedicated coordination with runner groups in Belagavi, Hubballi, Dharwad, Kolhapur & Bengaluru.
- **Athletic Associations:** Engaging district track & field clubs for competitive category participation.
- **Bulk Club Registration:** Priority registration batches and group bib allocations for running groups.

CHANNEL 02 · DC DIRECTIVES

Government Push

Letters to Officials & Government Schools

- **Official DC Circulars:** Formal letters dispatched to all government schools, PU colleges, and ITIs to send student runners.
- **Departmental Mobilization:** Directives to District Police, Sports Authority, NCC, NSS, and Scouts & Guides battalions.
- **Institutional Nominations:** Designated teacher coordinators at each school managing student batches.

CHANNEL 04 · MEDIA ENGINE

City-Wide Reach

Influencer Reels, Hoardings & Press

- **Regional Creators:** Kannada and Marathi travel/fitness influencers producing route-reveal reels shot at Belagavi Fort.
- **Prime Outdoor Hoardings:** High-visibility flex banners at Chennamma Circle, Fort, Central Bus Stand, and Lele Ground.
- **Print & Radio Press Note:** Official DC press release issued to leading Kannada and Marathi daily newspapers.

● EXECUTION TIMELINE

The 17-day critical countdown

17 Days between today's presentation and race morning. Every milestone is tightly sequenced to guarantee seamless execution.

10–12 Sep DC approval; traffic police route recce; school circulars issued.	12–14 Sep Registration portal live; school assembly visits start; pamphlet drive.	15–20 Sep Influencer reels live; run club mobilization; hoardings deployed.	22 Sep Photography, essay & drawing contest submissions close.	23–25 Sep Registrations close; T-shirt, cap, bib, and medal production complete.	26 Sep Advance bib collection; route marking, barricading & stage setup.	27 Sep EVENT DAY: 8 km Heritage Marathon & Website Inauguration.
--	--	--	---	---	---	---

Participant logistics, medals & safety plan

Professional race management ensuring safety, hydration, medical support, medals of recognition, and fresh refreshments.

PARTICIPANT LOGISTICS & HOSPITALITY

Registration, Medals & Refreshments

- **Online & Walk-In Registrations:** Seamless digital portal + school coordinator offline desk support.
- **Advance Bib Collection:** Open on 26 Sep at Lele Ground + race morning desk (05:30–06:15) to prevent start delays.
- **Finisher Recognition Medals:** High-quality engraved metal medals awarded to all 500 participants upon finishing.
- **Post-Run Refreshments:** Nutritious fresh bananas and chilled energy juice served immediately at the finish arch.

SAFETY, MEDICAL & TRAFFIC

Hydration, First Aid & Route Marshals

- **Hydration Corridors:** Water and electrolyte stations placed every 2 km along the course.
- **Advanced Medical Coverage:** Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ALS) ambulances trailing the pack and stationed at Fort.
- **Volunteer Route Marshals:** Trained volunteer marshals at every turn and major intersection.
- **Rolling Traffic Barricading:** Rolling road closures coordinated seamlessly with Belagavi Traffic Police.